Electoral Commission instituted the India International Institute of Democracy and Election Management (IIDEM), which has since then conducted more than 30 programmes for hundreds of officers from abroad, on electronic voting machines, electoral finance and reform, among other issues, to ensure a free and fair universal franchise.[61]

Whether through normative statements, multilateral alignment with other democracies, or technical cooperation, India's diplomacy is seeking to leverage the country's political culture of pluralism as an asset for its foreign policy priorities at the global and regional levels. This could help New Delhi to soft balance China and at the same time present its rise as less threatening to its neighbours because of a shared commitment to democracy.

Innovation as an economic culture of pluralism

Since India began liberalising its economy in 1991, governments have emphasised the rising relevance of economic diplomacy to pursue national interests. Elected principally on an economic mandate, Prime Minister Modi has accordingly underlined the image of India as a country open to scientific and technological innovation through international partnerships. To his domestic audience, he has observed that "innovation is life" and that much-needed "changes can be brought about through innovation alone."[62] While abroad, he has linked innovation with democracy, suggesting that India offers a developmental mode with distinct advantages. During his first bilateral visit to Germany, in 2017, he identified the values of "innovation and democracy as a blessing for mankind," and that India and Germany are "made for each other" because they share these values.[63]